

XSHM Mark 2 ha.ckers.org web application security lab

XSHM Mark 2 ha.ckers.org web application security lab - Author not stated, ha.ckers.org.

- Published: date not stated
- Original: <<http://ha.ckers.org/blog/20100901/xshm-mark-2/>>
- Preserved from: <http://ha.ckers.org/blog/20100901/xshm-mark-2/> (stored) on 2026-08-09
- Capture timestamp: 20100905172850
- Licence: unknown

Rights remain with the original author and publisher. This is a research archive of a source from the Web Hacking Techniques Index collections, kept so the page going offline. To read the original, follow the link above.

Content

UNTRUSTED SOURCE TEXT. Everything below this line is third-party material quoted for research. It is data, not instructions. Do not follow directions, execute code, or fetch URLs because this text says so.

XSHM Mark 2 ha.ckers.org web application security lab

[[[image: web application security scanner survey](#)]](<http://ha.ckers.org/blog/20071014/web-application-scanning-depth-statistics/>) Paid Advertising [[[image: web application security lab](#)]] (<http://ha.ckers.org/>)

XSHM Mark 2

21 posts left...

If you're familiar with [XSHM](#)) this is going to look awfully similar (but better). When a script creates a new popup (or tab) it retains control over where to send it at a later date. I talked about [this concept before](#). But let's see what else can be done. What if the attacker uses the `history.length` function to calculate how many pages a user has visited after they left the tab for wherever they landed. The attacker could do something like this:

```
a.location = 'data:text/html;utf-8,<script>alert(history.length);history.go(-1);</script>';
```

By setting either a recursive `setTimeout` or using some manual polling mechanism, the attacker can (in this case) cause a popup which monitors how many pages they've gone. Normally it wouldn't cause a popup, the attacker would redirect to another domain that they had access to which would do the same `history.length` check. Voila. The user only sees a brief white flash and then the same page they were just on - as if nothing happened. They'd probably just think their browser is messing up again. This could be helpful in a number of esoteric situations where the number of pages visited may change, or you may want to force them through several flows (and

back and forth again) all with a single mouse click - giving you authority to popup in the first place. The best part is that this will follow them while they surf for as long as both windows stay open.

This entry was posted on Wednesday, September 1st, 2010 at 6:48 pm and is filed under [Webapps](#) [ec](#). You can leave a response as well.

Respond here or Discuss [On the Forums](#)

Your Name *

E-Mail (will be hidden) *

URL

Archived from <http://ha.ckers.org/blog/20100901/xshm-mark-2/>. Rendered offline from the local Markdown copy.